they’re generally applicable any time you need to mix server-side logic with HTML generation.

One such example is generating links to other pages in your application using routing-based URL generation. Given that routing is designed to be fluid as you refactor your application, keeping track of the exact URLs the links should point to would be a bit of a maintenance nightmare if you had to do it by hand. As you might expect, there’s a Tag Helper for that: the Anchor Tag Helper.

18.3 Generating links with the Anchor Tag Helper

In chapters 6 and 15, I showed how you could generate URLs for links to other pages in your application using `LinkGenerator` and `IUrlHelper`. Views are another common place where you need to generate links, normally by way of an `<a>` element with an `href` attribute pointing to the appropriate URL.

In this section I show how you can use the Anchor Tag Helper to generate the URL for a given Razor Page using routing. Conceptually, this is almost identical to the way the Form Tag Helper generates the `action` URL, as you saw in section 18.2.1. For the most part, using the Anchor Tag Helper is identical too; you provide `asp-page` and `asp-page-handler` attributes, along with `asp-route-*` attributes as necessary. The default Razor Page templates use the Anchor Tag Helper to generate the links shown in the navigation bar using the code in the following listing.

Listing 18.9 Using the Anchor Tag Helper to generate URLs in _Layout.cshtml

```
<ul class="navbar-nav flex-grow-1">
    <li class="nav-item">
        <a class="nav-link text-dark"
            asp-area="" asp-page="/Index">Home</a>
    </li>
```